MANATOBI / ORIGINAL PRACTICE

英検2級
リーディングトレーニング

第13回 問題冊子

リスニング・英作文を含まない部分練習 ／ 全31問

大問	問題番号	内容
1	1〜17	短文の語句空所補充
2	18〜23	長文の語句空所補充
3	24〜31	読解

使い方

・解答用紙に答えを記入してください。問題冊子には正答を載せていません。
・問題・解説はA4縦、解答用紙はA4横。白黒・片面・実際のサイズ（100%）で印刷します。
・解き終わるまでは、別冊の解答・解説を開かないでください。
・同じ問題をアプリの分野別練習でも解けます。

独自作成した英検2級形式のリーディング第13回です。リスニング・英作文・面接は含みません。公式教材ではなく、CSE・合否換算はしません。筆記全体の公式時間をリーディングだけの時間に流用しません。外部難度校正は未実施です。

氏名：＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿

1

短文の語句空所補充
1〜4から最も適切な答えを一つ選び、解答用紙にマークしてください。

(1) Because river ice breaks up unpredictably in late March, kayak rentals remain ( ) until harbor patrol boats clear the channel.

1 surrounded **2** suspected **3** sustained **4** suspended

(2) Although the two violin bows weighed almost the same, the concertmaster noticed an ( ) improvement in bounce and tone with the older stick.

1 imaginary **2** immense **3** impartial **4** immature

(3) To stop coastal dunes from blowing onto the railway tracks, volunteers spent Saturday morning ( ) native beach grass along the ridge.

1 translating **2** transmitting **3** transplanting **4** transforming

(4) All overnight freight trains were routed around the valley ( ) rockfall inspections inside the north tunnel.

1 on account of **2** by means of **3** in favor of **4** on behalf of

(5) Before returning borrowed brass instruments at graduation, band seniors have every valve and slide professionally ( ).

1 surrendered **2** survived **3** surveyed **4** serviced

1　短文の語句空所補充（続き）

(6) Pediatricians are increasingly (　　) about energy drinks marketed to middle schoolers because caffeine disrupts adolescent deep sleep.

1 vocal　**2** vacant　**3** vague　**4** vain

(7) Installing rubber pads beneath the rooftop heat pump brought welcome (　　) to tenants sleeping on the top floor.

1 resentment　**2** quietude　**3** reluctance　**4** quarrel

(8) Had the ferry captain ignored the sudden drop in barometer readings, the vessel (　　) been caught in gale-force crosswinds offshore.

1 will have　**2** has　**3** might have　**4** may

(9) To keep fragile soy-milk skin intact while lifting it from hot vats, artisans slide flat bamboo skewers underneath lest it (　　).

1 tame　**2** tear　**3** tilt　**4** toil

(10) When salt spray corroded the seaside traffic signal box, technicians (　　) the rusted steel cabinet with fiberglass housing.

1 resembled　**2** rehearsed　**3** repelled　**4** replaced

1　短文の語句空所補充（続き）

(11) Although the twin pottery kilns use identical clay and pine firewood, glaze colors emerge (　　) warmer in the chamber closer to the chimney.

1 noticeably　**2** negligibly　**3** narrowly　**4** nominally

(12) Unsealed grain sacks stored in damp barns are (　　) to mold growth within a single rainy week.

1 profitable　**2** polite　**3** prone　**4** prior

(13) Neighborhood volunteers cleared fallen cedar branches to (　　) smooth ambulance access along the narrow hillside lane.

1 endure　**2** entitle　**3** enclose　**4** ensure

(14) With three veteran nurses retiring next spring, the clinic must take steps right away to make (　　) for the loss of night-shift staff.

1 out　**2** off　**3** up　**4** over

(15) Despite heavy promotion online, the subscription laundry service failed to catch (　　) among students who already had dorm washers.

1 up　**2** on　**3** out　**4** in

1　短文の語句空所補充（続き）

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(16) To avoid waking hospital patients at dawn, kitchen carts roll on soft polyurethane wheels that absorb floor (　　).

1 vibration　**2** vocation　**3** vegetation　**4** valuation

(17) Instead of tearing down the century-old silk warehouse, the city council voted to (　　) it into a youth chamber-music hall.

1 convict　**2** convene　**3** convey　**4** convert

2

長文の語句空所補充
1〜4から最も適切な答えを一つ選び、解答用紙にマークしてください。

Why Bridges Have Finger-Shaped Metal Joints

Drive or cycle across a long river bridge, and you will occasionally hear a rhythmic double thump beneath your tires while passing over a row of interlocking steel "fingers" set flush into the asphalt. Commuters rarely give those toothed metal plates a second glance, yet without expansion joints spaced carefully along the deck, a steel or concrete bridge would literally tear itself apart within a single year of seasonal weather.

Solid as bridge girders appear, every span behaves like a giant thermometer. On a freezing January midnight and a blazing August afternoon, a three-hundred-meter steel bridge can shrink and lengthen by more than fifteen centimeters as metal atoms vibrate faster in the heat. If engineers bolted both ends rigidly into concrete abutments, summer expansion would buckle the roadway upward, while winter contraction would crack supporting piers. (18), leaving a plain open slot wide enough to absorb fifteen centimeters of movement would create a dangerous trench capable of trapping bicycle wheels and jarring car suspensions.

Interlocking finger joints solve both problems elegantly. Two heavy steel plates cast with long tapered teeth are anchored to opposite deck sections so their fingers slide smoothly past one another as the bridge breathes in and out. Even when the gap opens widest in midwinter, vehicle tires roll continuously across overlapping steel teeth rather than dropping into a void. (19), rubber drainage troughs slung underneath catch salty slush and grit before runoff can rust structural bearings below.

Next time tires click softly over a bridge deck, that brief sound marks hardware that (20).

(18)

1 For example
2 At the same time
3 As a result
4 In other words

(19)

1 Conversely
2 Instead
3 Furthermore
4 Otherwise

(20)

1 lets giant structures flex with the seasons while keeping traffic safe
2 prevents steel bridges from expanding on hot summer days
3 heats icy roadways using electricity generated by passing tires
4 replaces concrete piers with floating rubber pontoons

How Rooftop Solar Panels Pair Well with Meadows

For years, architects designing flat commercial roofs treated green roofs and solar panels as competing choices: an owner could either lay trays of drought-hardy sedum plants to absorb stormwater or bolt down racks of photovoltaic modules to generate clean electricity. Across Germany, Switzerland, and Japan, however, building scientists are increasingly combining both systems into "biosolar" rooftops—discovering that plants and silicon cells actually help each other perform better.

A bare black waterproof membrane on a sunny July roof can easily bake at sixty-five degrees Celsius. Counterintuitively, solar panels lose electrical efficiency once their cells heat much above twenty-five degrees, dropping output just when afternoon air conditioners demand maximum power. When low-growing native wildflowers and mosses carpet the soil beneath raised panel frames, moisture evaporating gently from leaves cools the surrounding air by several degrees. (21), panels hovering overhead stay cooler and generate up to five percent more summer electricity than identical arrays mounted over bare gravel or tar.

The partnership works just as generously in reverse. Unshaded rooftop gardens often scorch into uniform mats of tough succulents, leaving little variety for urban insects. Angled solar frames create a patchwork of sunny strips, dappled shade, and rain-drip lines across the soil bed. (22), dozens of wildflower species bloom in staggered waves from April through October, feeding solitary bees and hoverflies high above busy streets.

Provided roof beams are engineered for wet soil weight, pairing greenery with solar arrays turns idle rooftops into (23).

(21)

1 Nevertheless
2 Previously
3 On the contrary
4 As a result

(22)

1 Thanks to those microclimates
2 Otherwise
3 In vain
4 Despite the flowers

(23)

1 heavy concrete parking decks that block all rainwater
2 dual-purpose spaces that boost clean power and urban biodiversity
3 heated greenhouses for growing tall tropical banana trees
4 ornamental gardens where solar wires are strictly banned

3 長文の内容一致選択
1〜4から最も適切な答えを一つ選び、解答用紙にマークしてください。

Preparing Pottery Pieces for the Raku Firing Day

From: Ceramics Club Advisor, Makoto Hori
To: All Registered Raku Workshop Potters
Subject: Clay choice and dress rules for Saturday's outdoor raku firing

Hello everyone,
Our outdoor raku firing behind the art studio is set for this Saturday from 9:30 a.m. Unlike ordinary electric kiln firings that cool slowly overnight, raku pieces are lifted red-hot from the gas kiln at nine hundred degrees with long iron tongs and placed straight into metal bins filled with dry sawdust.

Because of that extreme thermal shock, bowls thrown from smooth porcelain clay will shatter almost immediately. Every piece you bring on Saturday must already be bisque-fired using coarse grogged raku clay, whose tiny pre-fired sand particles open microscopic pathways for steam and heat to escape safely. Maximum height is eighteen centimeters so four pots fit per load.

For safety around glowing tongs and smoke, synthetic fleece jackets and nylon running shoes are not allowed near the kiln pad; please wear long-sleeved cotton denim, leather closed-toe shoes, and hair ties.

Makoto Hori

Preparing Pottery Pieces for the Raku Firing Day — Questions

(24) How does outdoor raku firing differ from an ordinary electric kiln firing?

1 Pots are frozen in snow before entering the kiln.

2 Pieces bake for three weeks without any glaze.

3 Red-hot pieces are pulled straight from the kiln with tongs and placed into dry sawdust.

4 Only unpainted plastic bowls can be fired.

(25) Why must participants use coarse grogged raku clay rather than smooth porcelain clay?

1 Porcelain clay melts iron tongs at room temperature.

2 Tiny sand particles in grogged clay let steam and heat escape without shattering the pot.

3 Grogged clay turns bright blue without glaze.

4 Grogged clay requires no bisque firing beforehand.

(26) What clothing rule must participants follow near the kiln pad on Saturday?

1 Leave shoes inside the classroom and work barefoot.

2 Wear short-sleeved nylon jerseys and open sandals.

3 Bring fleece blankets to wrap hot metal bins.

4 Wear cotton long sleeves and leather shoes rather than synthetic fleece or nylon footwear.

Why Hospital Architects Replace Long Echoing Halls

Step into a hospital ward built in the 1970s, and its floor plan usually follows a "racetrack" or single straight corridor stretching sixty meters from end to end, lined with glossy vinyl tiles and hard plaster ceilings. Architects back then prized unbroken sightlines and easy mopping. Acoustic measurements conducted over the past twenty years, however, revealed an unintended side effect: hard parallel walls bounce footsteps, pager beeps, and rolling cart clatter down the entire ward, pushing nighttime decibel levels far above World Health Organization guidelines for restorative sleep.

Elevated ward noise harms more than patient comfort. Sleep studies in cardiac and surgical recovery units show that repeated fifty-five-decibel noise spikes trigger brief surges in heart rate and stress hormones even when patients do not consciously recall waking up. Fragmented rest slows immune recovery and makes delirium more common among older adults. Nurses suffer too: in reverberant corridors where conversations blur together, staff report higher mental fatigue and must double-check spoken medication numbers more carefully to prevent misheard doses.

Modern hospital designers now attack corridor noise through both geometry and materials. Instead of one unbroken tunnel, wards are divided into shorter decentralized clusters curved gently around small nursing alcoves, cutting the distance sound can travel unchecked. Overhead, micro-perforated mineral tiles swallow speech frequencies while still meeting strict infection-control wiping standards, and poured rubber subfloors cushion stretcher wheels.

Several Scandinavian and Japanese teaching hospitals have paired structural redesign with "quiet-night protocols"—switching nurse call alerts from corridor loudspeakers to vibrating wrist badges after 9:00 p.m. and grouping routine blood-pressure checks so sleeping patients are disturbed less often.

Healing requires skilled medicine, yet architecture that guards quiet rest turns every night on the ward into part of the treatment.

Why Hospital Architects Replace Long Echoing Halls — Questions

(27) What acoustic problem did researchers find in 1970s straight hospital corridors?

1 Hard parallel surfaces reflected footsteps, carts, and beeps far down the ward, disrupting sleep.

2 Soft carpets absorbed emergency fire alarms completely.

3 Sixty-meter hallways blocked nurses from seeing beyond two doors.

4 Vinyl tiles dissolved whenever mopped with warm water.

(28) According to the second paragraph, how do nighttime noise spikes affect recovering patients?

1 They make surgical wounds heal twice as fast.

2 They bother only visitors sitting in daytime waiting rooms.

3 They cause brief jumps in heart rate and stress hormones even without conscious awakening, slowing recovery.

4 They help older adults sleep more deeply until noon.

(29) How do modern hospital architects reduce how far noise travels along a ward?

1 By stretching corridors to two hundred meters without doors.

2 By lining ceilings with polished steel mirrors.

3 By requiring nurses to crawl rather than walk at night.

4 By breaking long halls into shorter, gently curved clusters paired with sound-absorbing ceilings and rubber subfloors.

(30) What operational change is part of the "quiet-night protocols" mentioned in paragraph four?

1 Turning off all heart monitors between 9:00 p.m. and sunrise.

2 Waking every patient hourly to ask how well they are sleeping.

3 Sending nighttime call alerts to nurses' vibrating wrist badges instead of overhead speakers.

4 Locking nursing alcoves so nobody can answer calls at night.

Why Hospital Architects Replace Long Echoing Halls — Questions (continued)

(31) What overall message does the author convey at the end of the article?

1 Hospitals should return to glossy 1970s corridors to save mopping time.

2 Quiet ward design and thoughtful night routines support medical recovery alongside clinical care.

3 Acoustic ceiling tiles cannot be cleaned safely in hospitals.

4 Patients recover best in loud wards that mimic busy city streets.